

The 'Fikr' Project

Community Assistance Fund

A Proposal for Meaningful Collective Impact

Background & Context

Following our deep discussions with Rizwan about the real, ground-level problems that poor and financially vulnerable people face on a daily basis, we came to a conclusion. While our initial idea could not be implemented at that time, rather than leaving it there, we believe it is time to take our group to the next level and serve a meaningful purpose in today's society.

We see people around us struggling under the burden of inflation, medical expenses, education, food, rent, and basic necessities. Concurrently, many people genuinely want to help but lack a reliable avenue where their contributions will make a tangible difference.

The Core Proposal

We propose starting a small community assistance fund among ourselves. Every core member contributes at least **₹100 per week**. Anyone who is financially comfortable can contribute more according to their budget. If a weekly contribution is not possible, a bi-weekly contribution should be the minimum commitment.

The Power of Small Contributions:

If only our current core members contribute ₹100 every week:

9 members × ₹100 = **₹900/week**

This becomes approximately **₹3,600/month**, and within a few months, we can build a fund of **₹10,000+**.

This is only from the core members.

Operational Workflow

The system is designed to be transparent, collaborative, and strictly accountable. Below is the step-by-step process of how cases will be handled.

The Assistance Fund Process



1. Collection

All contributions will be collected in one designated fund/account. The money will not be distributed immediately. We first build the fund and then identify genuine cases.

2. Identification & Inspection

If any member comes across someone who genuinely needs financial assistance, they can report the case. For example, Samad's pharmacy gives him the opportunity to interact with different kinds of people daily, allowing him to identify genuine cases. However, anyone among us can identify and report a case.

Basic information must be collected: the situation, the help required, the approximate amount, and some form of verification.

3. Discussion & Decision

Suppose Akif identifies a person needing help and requests ₹5,000 from the fund. The case will be presented to the core members. We will discuss:

- What is the actual problem? Is the need genuine and urgent?
- How much assistance is actually required? Can we verify the situation?
- Should we provide the entire requested amount or only a portion?

After discussion, core members vote/agree on the amount to release. If ₹5,000 is requested but ₹3,000 is deemed sufficient, ₹3,000 will be released. The purpose is to ensure our limited funds reach those who genuinely need them.

4. Releasing the Fund

The Treasurer will be responsible for releasing the approved amount. Every transaction must be recorded: Date, Amount Collected, Amount Released, Purpose, Case/Reference, and Remaining Balance.

5. Help Beyond Money (Optional)

Sometimes the biggest problem is not money. Where possible, we will assist personally by helping with hospital formalities, finding government schemes, assisting with documentation, connecting individuals with relevant organizations, or guiding someone toward employment.

Team Structure & Roles

The core members of the initiative currently include:

- | | |
|------------------|--------------------|
| • Mohammad Yusuf | • Akif |
| • Amaan | • Belal |
| • Abdul Samad | • Ali Zaid Ibrahim |
| • Rizwan | • Imran |
| • Danish | • Umar |

To ensure smooth operations, we will formally define and periodically rotate the following roles:

Coordinator / Secretary

Manages discussions, meetings, and overall group coordination.

Treasurer

Maintains the fund, manages transactions, and keeps exact financial records.

Verification / Inspection Team

Verifies reported cases on the ground before they are brought for approval.

Core Members

Discuss cases collaboratively and decide whether/how much assistance to provide.

Supporters & External Contributors

Once we establish a transparent system, we can invite our contacts to contribute as supporters/donors. There will be a clear distinction:

- **Core Members:** Contribute and participate in decisions.
- **Supporters/Donors:** Contribute financially, but do not participate in internal decision-making.

If people find our system reliable and transparent, they can voluntarily contribute any amount (₹50, ₹100, ₹500). Collectively, it makes a massive difference.

Most Important Principle

This should not become a personal charity fund controlled by a few people. Most importantly, **no one should be embarrassed or publicly exposed for receiving help**. We are not trying to solve poverty—that would be unrealistic. But if our group can make even one person's difficult day a little easier, then our contributions will have served a meaningful purpose.

Future Goals (The Bigger Vision)

We are starting small, but if Allah blesses this initiative and gives us the strength to continue, we can take it to a larger scale:

1. **Build a larger community fund:** Grow from a few thousand rupees to a sustainable fund supporting larger, urgent cases.
2. **Expand beyond our circle:** Approach friends, relatives, and other groups to create a broader network of small contributors.
3. **Focus on recurring problems:** Expand support to cover medical treatment, education, essential food needs, and emergency assistance.
4. **Professionalize accountability:** Maintain proper financial records, verification procedures, and transparent expenditure reports.
5. **Build a volunteer network:** Establish volunteers in different areas to identify and verify genuine cases.
6. **Promote self-dependence:** Help people become financially independent through skill development and employment opportunities rather than just repeatedly giving money.

*"Start with ₹100. Build trust. Build a system. Build a community.
Then, InshaAllah, build something that can genuinely serve people at a much larger scale."*